

living in when it comes to their finances. I believe her work is so relevant when it comes to our ability to trust ourselves, and the strange relationship we often have with our finances. That's because many of us have a relationship with money that is toxic and unhelpful. We have a Money Story that's not serving us. Applying Brené's work can give us a great language to help us dig out, recognise, understand and adapt our Money Stories. That language includes asking the important question I posed in Chapter One: Is this Money Story serving or sabotaging me?

As we ask that question, we begin to reclaim our Money Story by becoming purposeful about our finances. We start to become curious about our own Money Story, our resulting behaviour and what its impact on our finances might be. I use the word 'curious' strategically here because we want to be inquisitive about our Money Story rather than automatically accepting of it. Being aware that we've probably picked up some Money Stories from our families, our friends and the media that at first glance seem innocuous and even helpful.

On my podcast *Uncensored Money*, the first questions I ask my guests are: 'What was your Money Story growing up? What did you reject and what did you keep?' Let's talk about answers provided by two of my guests: Jacqui Lewis from the Broad Place and Cathie Reid from Icon Group.

The Money Story Jacqui learned growing up was that to be successful you need to work really hard and for really long hours. In her words, you need to 'work till your eyes bleed'. Cathie's Money Story, a conservative one from her hardworking, risk-averse parents, was that you should buy a home and work hard to pay it off.

On the surface, both these Money Stories seem fair and logical. Work hard, own a home and pay it off as soon as you can. But they're Money Stories both women, at some stage in their lives, consciously rejected.

Jacqui talked about how she worked herself to a mental and physical breakdown because her Money Story taught her that working long hours and her own personal exertion were the only ways to achieve success. Notions she has since rejected, and she now runs a global meditation studio that teaches others how to create balance.

In Cathie's case, she spoke about needing to take a second mortgage on her home early on to fund her business (which is now worth more than \$1 billion). This meant rejecting her parents' Money Story of safety and